

BCBS

CLINICAL COVERAGE DETERMINATION GUIDELINE

Specialty Pharmacy: Dupixent (dupilumab) for Atopic Dermatitis

Policy: POL-RX-880 | Effective: 2026-01-15 | Specialty Pharmacy

COVERED PROCEDURES

J0875 - Injection, dupilumab, 1 mg subcutaneous

DIAGNOSIS CODES

- L20.9 - Atopic dermatitis, unspecified
- L20.89 - Other atopic dermatitis
- L20.81 - Atopic neurodermatitis

MEDICAL NECESSITY CRITERIA

All of the following must be documented for approval:

CRIT-1

Confirmed diagnosis of moderate-to-severe atopic dermatitis by dermatologist (IGA score ≥ 3 or EASI score ≥ 16 or BSA $\geq 10\%$)

Threshold: IGA ≥ 3 OR EASI ≥ 16 OR BSA $\geq 10\%$

CRIT-2

Failed or contraindicated to at least ONE topical corticosteroid (medium or high potency) used for minimum 4 weeks

Threshold: 4 weeks topical corticosteroid

CRIT-3

Failed or contraindicated to at least ONE topical calcineurin inhibitor (tacrolimus or pimecrolimus) used for minimum 4 weeks

Threshold: 4 weeks calcineurin inhibitor

CRIT-4

Failed, intolerant, or contraindicated to at least ONE systemic immunosuppressant (methotrexate, cyclosporine, azathioprine, or mycophenolate) used for minimum 3 months

Threshold: 3 months systemic immunosuppressant

CRIT-5

Prescribing physician is a dermatologist or allergist/immunologist

Threshold: dermatologist or allergist

CRIT-6

Patient is age 6 years or older

Threshold: 6 years

CRIT-7

No active systemic infection and TB screening completed

Threshold: TB negative, no active infection

URGENT BYPASS

Severe flare with erythroderma or hospitalization - expedited 24-hour review.

DENIAL REASONS

- Step therapy not completed (topical steroids, calcineurin inhibitors, or systemic agents not tried)
- Mild atopic dermatitis (IGA < 3 and EASI < 16 and BSA $< 10\%$)
- Prescriber is not dermatologist or allergist
- Patient under 6 years of age
- Active systemic infection or untreated latent TB